

Welcome to Business English

Welcome, and thank you for joining us. This course is about using the English you already have at work: writing clear emails and messages, handling phone and video calls, taking part in meetings, giving your opinion politely, presenting, negotiating, and applying for jobs. Every class is a practical workshop. You will hear a model, learn the key phrases, practice them out loud, and then use them in a realistic role-play.

Some of you use English at work every day; some of you are looking for a new job; some of you had a successful career in another country and are rebuilding it here. Your experience and your qualifications are **valued in this room**. Everyone starts from a different place, and everyone is measured against **their own starting point**, not against the person next to them.

WHEN AND WHERE

Days:

Time:

Place / Room:

First class:

Last class:

Break:

The course runs for **8 weeks**, with **2 classes** a week. Each class lasts **90 minutes**, so there are **16 classes** in total. Here is the plan:

Week	First class of the week		Second class of the week	
Week 1	C1	Orientation and needs analysis: a short survey, a reply email, a 3-minute speaking sample	C2	1.1 Register, tone & first impressions
Week 2	C3	1.2 Professional emails & messaging	C4	1.3 Telephoning & virtual calls
Week 3	C5	2.1 Meetings: participating & chairing	C6	2.2 Small talk, networking & rapport
Week 4	C7	2.3 Diplomatic & assertive communication	C8	Midpoint performance check: an email and a message, a phone call and a short meeting
Week 5	C9	3.1 Presentations: structure & delivery	C10	3.2 Negotiations: language & strategy
Week 6	C11	3.3 Pitching, persuasion & objections	C12	4.1 Reports, proposals & documents
Week 7	C13	4.2 CVs, cover letters & job interviews	C14	4.3 Review project: plan and rehearse
Week 8	C15	Final, part A: timed writing + a negotiation in pairs	C16	Final, part B: your presentation or pitch + a short mock interview, then certificates 🎓

WHAT TO BRING



a notebook



a pen



your phone
(on silent)



water

Your teacher will give you a **workbook** and a **performance tracker**. Please bring both to **every** class, with a folder for your written work. We use phones to record practice calls and presentations, so you can hear yourself. **Optional:** a job advertisement or an email from work that you want help with (remove any private details first).

HOW A CLASS WORKS

Link to your work → See a model → Notice the key phrases → Say them out loud → Practice on paper → Role-play → Feedback

 Please arrive **on time**. We start with a short warm-up that reviews the last class.

 Keep your phone **on silent**, and use it for class tasks only.

 Role-plays are **practice, not a performance**. Everyone plays roles, and everyone makes mistakes.

 Your teacher notes mistakes during a role-play and discusses them **afterwards**, without names.

 Workplaces differ. We compare what is **usual** in different places, and no way is "wrong".

 If you can't come, please **let your teacher know**, and do the online lesson at home.

🔒 Your private information stays private: the role-card option

You **never** have to share your salary, whether you are working, your immigration status, or the name of your employer. For **any** task about your job or career, you can choose a **role card**: a fictional job at a fictional company (for example, a project coordinator at *Northwind Logistics*). Use your real situation or a role card, whichever you prefer, and you can change your mind at any time. Your teacher marks your **English**, not your story. The same is true for your CV and interview practice in Week 7.

✓ HOW YOUR WORK IS MARKED

Every email, call, meeting, presentation, and interview in this course is marked with the **same four criteria**. Each one gets a score from **1 to 5**, so the total is **out of 20**.

Criterion	In plain words, the question is...
Task & Purpose	Did you do the job? Did you cover all the points, and is it clear what happens next?
Register & Tone	Is it right for the person and the situation: polite, not too formal and not too casual, diplomatic when it needs to be?
Language Range & Accuracy	Did you use useful work phrases, correct grammar, and the right words?
Organization & Delivery	Is it easy to follow? A clear structure, signposts, and, when you speak, clear pronunciation and good listening.

1

Not yet: the message is hard to understand

2

Partly there: some points are missing or unclear

3

Gets the job done, with some problems

4

Clear and appropriate, with small slips

5

Confident and professional

You get scores in **Class 1** (your starting point), **Class 8** (the midpoint check), and **Classes 15–16** (the final). Write them on your **performance tracker**. Your scores are **private**: you decide whether to share them.

🗣️ USEFUL PHRASES FOR CLASS

ASKING ABOUT LANGUAGE

Is this too formal for an email to a colleague?

What's a more polite way to say "___"?

Would you say this in a meeting?

IN A ROLE-PLAY

Sorry, could you say that again, please?

Just to check, do you mean...?

Could I just come in here?

🏠 AT HOME: FREE ONLINE LESSONS

📱 Business English: free

Each of the **12 lessons** we teach in class has a matching **online lesson** with the phrase banks, model emails and conversations, and exercises with answers. It's your homework, and it helps you catch up if you miss a class. It works on a phone, a tablet, or a computer.

rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/

- 1 Open the website, or scan the QR code with your phone camera.
- 2 Choose the lesson your teacher gives you (for example, **Lesson 1.2**).
- 3 Press the  **Listen** buttons to hear the model sentences. Say each line **with** the audio, copying the stress and the polite, friendly intonation. (No sound? Turn up the volume, or try the Chrome browser.)
- 4 Do the exercises **before** you check the answers. Then use one new phrase in real life that week.



Scan me 

Aim for **45–60 minutes**, **2 times** a week. Translation help and free practice tools:

rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum/learning-tools.html

The class and the online lessons both use American English (*CV* and *résumé* mean the same document). British forms are correct too: choose one style and keep it consistent.

📈 What to expect: realistic progress

- In eight weeks, most learners notice the biggest change in **confidence** and in **register and tone**: knowing which phrase fits which situation. These changes show quickly.
- **Grammar accuracy** and **fluency** improve more slowly, because they depend on habits built over months. That is normal.
- A gain of **2–4 points out of 20** between Class 1 and the final is a good result. Some learners gain more; nobody can promise a number.
- No course can guarantee a job or a promotion. This one gives you **tools** for emails, calls, meetings, and interviews that you keep using.

👤 Myteacher

Name: _____ Phone / text: _____

Email: _____ Office hours: _____

Can't come? Send a short, professional message (good practice!): "Hi _____, I'm afraid I can't attend today's class. I'll complete the online lesson before the next one. Best regards, _____."

☀️ YOU'RE READY TO START

Good workplace English is not about perfect grammar. It is about **getting things done** with people: being clear, being polite, and being understood. You already have these skills in your own language; this course helps you bring them into English, one role-play at a time. We're glad you're here. Welcome.